INTERVIEW TRANSCRIPTS

INTERVIEW 1

Amy: Hi Dai. Thank you for taking the time to participate in this interview. I am conducting research into people's experiences at concerts and music festivals, particularly how attendees communicate with friends, use their phones and respond to crowded or sensory-intense environments.

Your participation is voluntary. You can skip any question or stop the interview at any time. With your permission, I would like to record and transcribe our conversation for analysis within this university project. Your responses will only be used for the project.

Participant 1: Yes, that is fine. I'm happy to participate.

Amy: Great, thank you. To begin, can you tell me about the most recent concert or music festival you attended?

Participant 1: The most recent concert I attended was Lana Del Rey's concert in London last August. I went with four friends, so there were five of us altogether. We had planned it for quite a while because several of us are big fans of her music. It was also one of the largest concerts I had attended, so the atmosphere was very exciting, but it was also quite crowded and sometimes difficult to navigate.

Amy: What did you enjoy the most, and what was difficult or frustrating during the event?

Participant 1: I enjoyed the atmosphere the most. Hearing the songs performed live and being surrounded by so many people who knew the lyrics created a strong sense of connection. There were moments when the entire audience sang together, and that felt very different from listening to the same songs alone.

The most frustrating part was probably the crowd. Moving between areas was slow, particularly before and after the performance. It was difficult to access the toilets and food areas because the queues were long, and we did not always know which route would be less crowded. It was also sometimes difficult to see the stage because many people were holding their phones above their heads to record.

Amy: How did the phone recording affect your experience?

Participant 1: I understand why people wanted to record, because it was a special event, and I also recorded some parts. However, when many people were recording at the same time, it blocked the view. Sometimes I found myself watching the stage through another person's phone screen instead of seeing it directly.

Amy: Who did you attend with, and how did your group normally communicate or coordinate during the event?

Participant 1: I went with four friends from university. Before entering, we used a group chat to organise when and where to meet. We also agreed that if we became separated, we would meet near one of the food stalls after the performance.

During the concert, communication was much more difficult. We could not hear each other clearly, so we mainly used hand gestures or spoke directly into each other's ears. If someone wanted to go to the toilet or buy water, they would usually tell the person next to them, who would then pass the message along to the others.

Amy: Did one person take responsibility for organising the group, or was it shared?

Participant 1: One friend was more organised and had all the tickets and transport information, so we depended on her quite a lot. The rest of us contributed, but she was definitely the main organiser. During the concert, we tried to look after the people standing beside us, but it was difficult to communicate across the whole group.

Amy: Have you ever been separated from your friends at a concert or festival? What happened, and how did you find each other again?

Participant 1: Yes. During the Lana Del Rey concert, one of my friends and I went to buy water. When we returned, the crowd had moved and we could not find the exact place where the others were standing. We sent messages in the group chat, but they were not delivered immediately.

We tried calling, but it was too loud to hear properly. Eventually, one friend sent us a photograph of a large sign near their location. We used the sign and some nearby lights as landmarks and found them again after around fifteen or twenty minutes.

Amy: How did you feel while you were separated?

Participant 1: I was not extremely worried because I was with one other person, and we knew the general area where our friends were. However, it was stressful because the performance had already started, and we were missing part of it while trying to find them. I was also worried that moving through the crowd might disturb other people.

Amy: Have poor phone reception, low battery, loud music or crowded spaces made it difficult to communicate with your group? How?

Participant 1: Yes, definitely. The poor reception was probably the biggest issue because messages did not arrive immediately. A message saying where someone was standing was sometimes no longer useful by the time it arrived because the crowd had shifted.

The loud music made phone calls almost impossible. Even if someone answered, we could not understand each other. My battery also became quite low because I had been using maps, taking photos and videos, and messaging throughout the day. I started saving my battery in case I needed it for transport after the concert.

The crowd made it difficult as well because I did not feel comfortable stopping suddenly to look at my phone. I had to pay attention to the people around me and make sure I was not blocking the path.

Amy: How often did you use your phone during the event, and did using it ever distract you from the performance?

Participant 1: I used it quite often before the performance for tickets, directions, messages and photos. During the performance, I recorded parts of approximately five or six songs, particularly the songs I liked most. I did not record the entire songs, but I probably recorded between thirty seconds and one minute each time.

It did distract me to some extent. When I was recording, I paid attention to whether the video was stable and whether the artist was visible on the screen. I was not fully focused on the music or the atmosphere. Later, I realised that I had several similar videos that I did not really need.

Amy: Why did you feel that you wanted to record those moments?

Participant 1: Mainly because I wanted to keep a memory of the concert. I also wanted to share a few clips with friends who could not attend. There was also a feeling that if I did not record my favourite song, I might regret it later. However, when I watched the videos afterward, the sound quality was not very good, and they did not capture how the concert actually felt.

Amy: If there were another way to preserve those moments, do you think you would record less?

Participant 1: Yes, probably. If I knew that I would receive a good-quality official clip or photograph from a moment I selected, I would not feel as much pressure to record it myself. I would still want to take a few personal photos, especially with my friends, but I would not need to hold my phone up during so many songs.

Amy: How would you feel about experiencing rhythm, bass or other musical elements through vibration?

Participant 1: I think it could be interesting, especially because you already feel some bass through the floor and your body at a live concert. A device that translates parts of the music into vibration could make the experience more immersive. It could also provide another way for Deaf or hard-of-hearing attendees to experience elements of the performance.

However, I think the vibration would need to be carefully designed. If it only produced the same strong vibration repeatedly, it might feel more like a phone notification than part of the music.

Amy: Could continuous vibration become distracting or uncomfortable? When should users be able to adjust or disable it?

Participant 1: Yes, continuous vibration could become uncomfortable, especially during a long concert. Some people may also be sensitive to strong physical sensations. Users should be able to adjust the intensity at any time and turn it off completely.

It might be better if people could choose which parts of the music they wanted to feel, such as only the bass or major changes in rhythm. There should also be a clear difference between vibrations representing music and vibrations communicating important information. Otherwise, users might become confused or ignore the signals.

Amy: Have you experienced any difficulty accessing things such as seating, toilets, exits, quiet spaces, accessible areas or event information?

Participant 1: The toilets were difficult to access because the queues were long and the signs were not always visible from within the crowd. We also had trouble identifying the best exit after the concert because everyone moved in the same direction, and the mobile internet was unreliable.

I did not personally require an accessible viewing area, but I noticed that the event information did not make accessibility features very visible to the general audience. I was not aware of any quiet space. If one existed, I would not have known where to find it.

There was also limited seating in the general area. After standing and walking for several hours, some people sat on the ground, which made movement more difficult and potentially unsafe.

Amy: Did you experience a point when you needed a break?

Participant 1: Yes, before the main performance, I felt tired and wanted to sit down for a while. We found an area away from the densest part of the crowd, but it was still noisy and busy. It did not feel like a proper rest area.

Amy: When you needed a break, help or wanted to separate from your group temporarily, how did you communicate this to your friends?

Participant 1: I usually told the person standing closest to me and asked them to tell the others. If I wanted to leave the group for a while, I would also send a message so there was a written record of where I was going.

The difficult part was that I sometimes avoided asking for a break because I did not want the group to lose its position or miss part of the performance. I think people can feel guilty about changing the group's plans, particularly when everyone has paid a lot to attend.

Amy: What could make it easier for someone to express that need?

Participant 1: It would help if the group agreed beforehand that people could take breaks or separate without feeling that they were disrupting the experience. A simple way to communicate "I am safe, but I need a break" could also be helpful, especially if it did not require writing a message in the crowd.

At the same time, I would want control over what was shared. I would be comfortable telling my friends that I was taking a break, but I would not want personal health information or an exact location shared with everyone.

Amy: If you could improve one thing about the concert or festival experience, what would you change and why?

Participant 1: I would try to reduce the pressure people feel to record the performance while still allowing them to preserve meaningful memories. I do not think phones should be completely banned because people use them for tickets, safety, accessibility and communication. People also have the right to capture personal memories.

However, it would be useful to have an alternative. For example, attendees could press a physical button or interact with their ticket when a meaningful moment occurs. After the concert, they could receive a short official clip, the song title and perhaps a shared memory showing which friends selected the same moment.

That would allow people to keep something from the performance without holding their phones up for a long time. It could help them focus more on the music and reduce the number of screens blocking other people's views.

Amy: What would make that experience feel personal rather than receiving the same concert recording as everyone else?

Participant 1: It could include the exact moments I selected, a short reflection or emotion I added afterward, and information about which friends marked the same moments. I would also like to include photos we took together before or after the performance. The official content would provide the quality, but our choices and reflections would make it personal.

Amy: Would you have any privacy or consent concerns about a system like that?

Participant 1: Yes. I would want to know whether the official footage included identifiable audience members and how long the interaction data was stored. It should not automatically post anything to social media. Attendees should choose what they save, share or delete.

Artists should also have control over which performances or clips can be distributed. The system should preserve memories without encouraging people to collect and share everything automatically.

Amy: Is there anything else about the concert experience that you think is important for this project?

Participant 1: I think the project should recognise that phone use is not entirely negative. Phones are useful for safety, tickets, directions, accessibility and communication. The issue is more about finding a balance.

Technology should not punish people for recording or suggest that there is only one correct way to enjoy music. It should offer an appealing alternative that allows people to feel present while still knowing they can keep a meaningful memory afterward.

Amy: That is very helpful. Thank you for sharing your experiences and perspectives. Your responses will be very helpful for us.

Participant 1: No problem! I'm glad I could help. Okay, I gotta go, see ya!

INTERVIEW 2

Amy: Hi Thanh. Thanks for joining me today. I'm researching people's experiences at concerts and music festivals, including how they interact with their companions, manage crowded environments and use technology during an event.
Taking part is completely voluntary. You may decline to answer any question or end the interview whenever you wish. Do I have your permission to record and transcribe our discussion for this university project?

Participant 2: Yes, you do.

Amy: Thank you. To start, what was the most recent concert or music festival you attended?

Participant 2: My most recent concert was Billie Eilish in Brisbane 2 years ago. I attended with my cousins and a few friends. I also went to Những Thành Phố Mơ Màng (NTPMM) in Vietnam after that.
I found them quite different. At Billie Eilish, the entire audience was there for one main performer, so the experience felt very focused and intense. NTPMM lasted longer and featured several artists, so we spent more time moving between performances, getting food and deciding what to do next.

Amy: What was the best part of those experiences for you?

Participant 2: At the Billie Eilish concert, my favourite part was hearing familiar songs performed live. The audience's reaction made the music feel much more emotional. I especially enjoyed

the stage production because the sound, lighting and crowd energy worked together.
At NTPMM, I enjoyed the overall environment. It was not only about watching one performance. We could walk around, discover artists and spend time together. It felt similar to a shared day out rather than only a concert.

Amy: Was there anything you found difficult or frustrating?

Participant 2: The number of people made many simple activities more difficult. It took a long time to move between areas, buy food or reach the toilets. It was also hard to check the schedule because the internet became slow when the venue was busy.
Another concern for me was keeping my phone safe. When people are standing close together, I become more aware of the possibility of pickpocketing. I used a small bag that stayed in front of my body, but I still checked it regularly.

Amy: Who did you attend with, and how did you organise yourselves?

Participant 2: I attended with both friends and cousins. Before each event, we used a group chat to share the tickets, travel arrangements and performance schedule. For the festival, each person also chose the artists they were most interested in seeing.
We did not expect to remain together for the entire event because our interests were different. We planned to separate for some performances and meet again later. We normally selected a large landmark rather than relying only on live location sharing.

Amy: How did you communicate once you were inside the venue?

Participant 2: If we were already together, we communicated face-to-face or used simple gestures. Sometimes we had to speak very closely because the music was too loud.
When we were apart, we depended on messaging. The problem was that messages were not always delivered immediately. A person could send their location and then move somewhere else before the rest of the group received it.

Amy: Did anyone in the group take on most of the coordination work?

Participant 2: My cousin did more of it than the rest of us. She downloaded screenshots of the map, tickets and timetable before we arrived. That was very useful when the internet stopped working properly.
However, it also meant that everyone kept asking her for information. She spent more time checking details and making decisions, while the rest of us were able to follow her. I think that placed some unfair pressure on her.

Amy: Were you ever separated unexpectedly?

Participant 2: Yes, at Những Thành Phố Mơ Màng. A few of us left the performance area to get drinks and food. When we returned, the crowd had grown, and we could not get back to the position where the others had been standing.

We tried sending messages, but the connection was unstable. We described the signs and food stalls around us, but the venue had many similar-looking stalls. After several unsuccessful messages, we moved to a landmark we had passed earlier and asked the others to meet us there.

Amy: How long did it take to reunite?

Participant 2: I think it took around twenty minutes. It felt longer because we were missing the performance while waiting.

Amy: What was going through your mind at that point?

Participant 2: I was mainly annoyed by the situation, but I was also uncertain about whether the others had seen our messages. I was not alone, so I did not feel unsafe, but I wanted confirmation that everyone was okay.
I also avoided holding my phone openly for too long. The area was very crowded, and I was worried that I might drop it or that someone could take it without me noticing.

Amy: Apart from unreliable internet, did other factors make communication difficult?

Participant 2: The noise made phone calls almost pointless. Even when someone answered, I could only hear parts of what they were saying. The crowd also made it difficult to stop and type because people were moving around me.
Battery life became another concern later in the day. I had used my phone for the ticket, messages, the camera, the schedule and payment. I still needed enough battery to contact my family and arrange transport after leaving, so I started limiting how often I checked it.

Amy: Approximately how often did you use your phone during the performance?

Participant 2: I checked it regularly, but not always for the same purpose. Sometimes I was looking for a message, checking the time or confirming the next performance. I also took photos and recorded short videos of songs I recognised.
During Billie Eilish, I recorded several parts because I wanted something to remember afterward. I did not film complete songs, but I probably spent more time recording than I originally intended.

Amy: Did recording affect how you experienced the performance?

Participant 2: Yes. When I recorded, I concentrated on keeping the artist inside the frame and avoiding other people's heads. I was physically present, but my attention was divided between the stage and the screen.
There was also some pressure to capture the most famous songs. As soon as one began, almost everyone around me raised their phones, and I felt that I should do the same. Later, I realised that many of my videos looked similar and had poor sound quality.

Amy: Do you still value having those recordings?

Participant 2: I value a small number of them, particularly the ones connected to my favourite songs. However, I did not watch most of the clips again. A recording can show what happened, but it does not reproduce the feeling of being there.
I think I would prefer to have a few meaningful, high-quality memories rather than many videos that I never revisit.

Amy: How would you feel about experiencing aspects of the music, such as rhythm or bass, through vibration?

Participant 2: I would be interested in trying it. At a concert, the bass is already physical, so adding carefully designed vibration could create another layer of the performance. It could also give Deaf and hard-of-hearing attendees greater access to the rhythm.
For me, convenience would be essential. I would not want to carry a heavy vest or another object in my hands. A small wristband, pendant or clip would be more practical.

Amy: Do you think ongoing vibration could become uncomfortable?

Participant 2: It could. If the vibration continued at the same strength for several hours, I might become irritated by it or stop noticing it altogether.
The wearer should be able to change the intensity directly on the device and pause it whenever necessary. They should not need to unlock their phone and search through settings during a performance.
Music vibration should also be different from functional notifications. A message from a friend, a safety warning and the beat of a song should not feel identical.

Amy: Did you encounter any difficulties with seating, toilets, exits, quiet spaces or event information?

Participant 2: Finding a place to rest was difficult at the festival. After standing for a long time, we wanted to sit down, but there were not many suitable places. Some people sat on the ground, which reduced the space available for others to walk.
The toilet queues were also very long. We could see where the facilities were, but there was no easy way to know whether another toilet area was less busy.
When the event ended, the exits became congested. We followed the movement of the crowd because the signs were difficult to see from our position. I was not aware of a quiet area, and if one was available, it had not been clearly communicated to us.

Amy: What did you do when you needed a break or wanted to leave the group temporarily?

Participant 2: I usually spoke to my cousin first because she was the person keeping track of the plan. If I was leaving with someone else, we told the group where we intended to go and when we expected to return.
If we were already separated, I used the group chat. However, because the connection was

unreliable, I could not assume that the message had been received.
There were also times when I stayed with the group even though I wanted to rest. I did not want everyone to change their plan because of me.

Amy: What might make that communication easier?

Participant 2: I would like a very simple way to send a few essential messages without taking out my phone. For example, a wearable could communicate “I’m okay,” “I need a break,” “I’m going to the meeting point” or “please check on me.”
It would be especially useful if it could function through a local connection rather than depending on venue Wi-Fi or mobile data. That would let me keep my phone secured inside my bag.
The interaction would need to be easy to remember. I would not want ten buttons or many complicated vibration patterns. Three or four clear actions would probably be enough.

Amy: What type of wearable would be most convenient?

Participant 2: A wristband would be easy to access quickly, although it would need to fit comfortably beside a watch or festival entry band. A necklace or a small clip attached to clothing could also work.
Whichever form it takes, it should be light, secure and difficult to remove accidentally. I would also prefer something that I can operate by touch without needing to look down.

Amy: You mentioned concern about pickpocketing. How could technology address that without creating a false sense of security?

Participant 2: The main benefit would be reducing how often I need to expose my phone. If tickets, simple messages and basic event information were available through another device, my phone could remain zipped inside my bag.
A wearable might also alert me if it loses connection with my phone unexpectedly. However, that feature would need to account for temporary connection failures. If it produced false alarms every few minutes, users would stop trusting it.
I would not describe it as preventing theft completely. It would be more accurate to say that it reduces phone handling and provides an early warning in some situations.

Amy: If you could change one thing about the overall concert or festival experience, what would it be?

Participant 2: I would reduce the event’s dependence on smartphones. At the moment, the phone is used for almost everything: entry, schedules, payments, maps, communication, photography and transport. That creates problems when the battery becomes low, the internet fails or the crowd makes phone use unsafe.
I would introduce a small, optional wearable containing only essential features. It could provide offline event details, allow a few group signals and reduce the need to remove a phone from a secure bag.

Amy: Could that device also support people who want to record less and focus more on the performance?

Participant 2: Yes. It might include a simple way to bookmark a meaningful moment. If I pressed the wearable during a song, the system could save the time and provide an approved photograph or short clip afterward.
Knowing that the moment had been saved would allow me to continue watching instead of opening my camera. I would still want the freedom to take personal photos, but I might record fewer videos.

Amy: What would make the saved memory personal to you?

Participant 2: I would want to choose the moment myself rather than receive a generic concert package. The memory could include the song, an official image or short video and a note that I add afterward.
It would also be meaningful to see whether my cousins or friends selected the same part of the performance. That could form a shared timeline of what mattered to us as a group.

Amy: What concerns would you have about using such a device?

Participant 2: I would want clear information about privacy. It should not constantly track my exact position, and it should not share my data automatically. I should decide which friends can receive my signals and whether anything is posted online.
Cost would also affect whether I used it. I would not purchase an expensive wearable for a single concert. It would be more realistic if the venue loaned it to attendees, included it in the ticket or allowed it to be returned and reused.
Finally, it must remain optional. Some people may prefer their phones, and others may not want vibration or location-based features.

Amy: Is there anything else you would like the design team to consider?

Participant 2: The technology should simplify the experience rather than create another responsibility. If I have to charge it constantly, connect it manually or learn many controls, I would probably return to using my phone.
I would prioritise reliability, security and ease of use over adding many features. Ideally, I could keep my phone safe, access essential information and enjoy the performance with fewer interruptions.

Amy: Thank you, Thanh. Your experiences provide a useful perspective for us.

Participant 2: You’re welcome. I hope the project goes well. Bye Bye!

INTERVIEW 3

Serafina: Okay, I'm recording. So for the first question, can you tell me about the most recent concert or music festival you attended?

Participant 3: Um, the most recent concert I attended was Ethel Caine in Brisbane.

Serafina: And what is it like?

Participant 3: Oh, it was really great. It was at the 42 Music Hall, so it's a smaller venue. It was my first time there. I didn't know the concert etiquette yet for the specific artist, but turns out people were lining up since like 6am.

Serafina: Oh, okay.

Participant 3: And I only got there at 3pm because I wasn't that big of a fan of hers. I got tickets for like really cheap the night before, so I was like, okay, why not? But that concert actually made me like really love her. But yeah, I was there at 3pm. The line was really… Yeah, it was a really long line, but we were in fast. Like, yeah, there was no problem. And yeah, it was really nice. It was a… I feel like that was my favourite concert that I've ever been to, lowkey. But yeah, I feel like because it was like a smaller venue, you feel closer and it's a lot less stuffy.

Serafina: Oh, okay. So what did you enjoy the most about the concert? And what was the difficult or frustrating thing during the event?

Participant 3: What I enjoyed the most was lowkey just the first stage presence and the venue itself. Because I feel like, like I said before, because it was small, you feel a lot closer to the artists and you don't have to line up for that long. And the difficulty I faced is probably just a me problem because I'm short. And Australian people are tall, especially the men. But one cool thing that happened was I was blocked by this guy, by this tall guy in front of me, but he went with his girlfriend that was short. I think midway to the concert, the girl realised that and she dragged him back.

Serafina: Oh, okay. That's nice. So who did you go with? And how did your group normally communicate or coordinate during the event?

Participant 3: I went with three of my friends. We coordinated by… Yeah, we all live in the same apartment building. So we just met up there and we went to the venue together. And yeah, I feel like it was… We didn't all buy tickets at the same time because one of us already got tickets from like a while ago. Because yeah, and like one of us got tickets a while ago and the other three, we got it the night, like a night or two before.

Serafina: Okay. So have you ever been separated from your friends at a concert or festival? And what happened and how did you find each other again?

Participant 3: On that specific concert, we kind of got separated because two of us had to go to the toilet. But again, since it was a small venue, it was pretty easy to find the other person. Have

I ever gotten lost? Maybe not I can't recall a time here. But back in Indonesia, when I was in high school or middle school, I've once lost my friends. Our group got separated in two and there was no signal because it was really packed. But so I think at that point, because it was a festival, so people just went on their way. Like, yeah, we just watched what we wanted to watch and we ended up finding each other anyway.

Serafina: Oh, okay. Yeah. So did you actually like call each other or how did you guys-

Participant 3: We couldn't.

Serafina: Oh, okay.

Participant 3: Yeah, because it was like a festival so there was no signal.

Serafina: Oh, okay.

Participant 3: Yeah, it was… Yeah.

Serafina: Okay.

Participant 3: And I feel like also, it's easier… I feel like with like normal concerts, it's hard to lose your friends because you just stick to one place. But like with festivals, it's like…

Serafina: Oh, it's harder for festivals?

Participant 3: Yes.

Serafina: Okay. So have you ever had like poor phone reception, low battery, loud music, or crowded space that made it difficult to communicate with your group?

Participant 3: Yes, all of them. Especially, yeah, again, with festivals. I don't know how people haven't figured that one out yet, but it's always bad reception and you can't get a hold of your friends.

Serafina: Mm-hmm. And so how often did you use your phone during the event and did using it ever distract you from the performance?

Participant 3: No, I don't think it ever distracted me. I used it to take videos.

Serafina: Oh, okay.

Participant 3: Yeah, I wouldn't… Yeah, I wouldn't go to some concert that I paid like a bunch of money. And just play on my phone, no.

Serafina: Okay, okay.

Participant 3: I'm very in the moment. And I try not to touch my phone.

Serafina: Okay, so you don't really use it that often?

Participant 3: I don't really use it. And again, you don't get signal there, so you don't even get your text in.

Serafina: Oh, okay,

Participant 3: There's nothing on your phone to see.

Serafina: Okay. So how would you feel about experiencing like rhythm or bass or other musical elements through like vibration?

Participant 3: Yeah, I feel like that really… I feel like a good sound system really makes or breaks a festival. Because, yeah, it really brings out the vibe, especially if it's a more upbeat kind of situation where people all jump and jump around and everything. That's always really fun.

Serafina: Okay, so it doesn't bother you? Like if you experience it like through vibrations and all that?

Participant 3: No, no, not really. It just depends on the crowd.

Serafina: Okay, so could continuous vibration become…Oh, you already answered that. So when do you think users should be able to adjust or disable like continuous vibration so it doesn't become like distracting or uncomfortable?

Participant 3: I feel like that's… I feel like the users should know when they're going into something, how it's gonna be. Because, for example, like an EDM festival, something like Ultra, that you know going into that, that's gonna be like a harder electronic music and the vibrations are gonna be harder and everything. And if you need to accommodate for that, you need to, yeah, find out more beforehand. And yeah, I feel like it's very easily avoided.And if not, then that means that's the venue's fault.

Serafina: So have you experienced any difficulty accessing things such as like seatings, toilets, exits, quiet spaces, accessible areas, or event information?

Participant 3: Oh, I don't really look for those.

Serafina: Oh, okay. You don't look for toilets?

Participant 3: Oh, for toilets. With concerts, not really because I try my best to pee beforehand because I don't want to lose my spot. But with festivals, I feel like it's usually always really clear. There's gonna be like a line of port-a-potty and I don't think you can miss it.

Serafina: But what about like quiet spaces? Because like maybe there's like spaces that are too crowded for you or anything like that.

Participant 3: Oh, quiet spaces, you just go to the back.

Serafina: Oh, okay. So you don't have trouble with that?

Participant 3: No.

Serafina: Okay.

Serafina: Um, when you needed a break, help, or wanted to separate from your group for a while, how do you communicate this to your friends?

Participant 3: Um, I don't because I feel like it's a bit dangerous to be separated from your friends.

Serafina: Okay, so you just stay together?

Participant 3: Yeah, just stay together.

Serafina: Okay, but would like in other circumstances, would you ever consider doing it?

Participant 3: Like in a non-concert situation?

Serafina: No, like in a concert, but like maybe it's urgent or whatever. Would that ever come up? Like, I don't know.

Participant 3: Uh, I don't think so. Because I don't think I would want to separate myself from my friends in a concert. Like I said, bad reception and everything. You lose your friend, you're not gonna find them again.

Serafina: Okay, okay, okay. So, um, if you could improve one thing about the concert or festival experience, what would you change and why?

Participant 3: Good reception, please.

Serafina: Good reception?

Participant 3: Yes, just good reception. So just, yeah, just I feel like with festivals, you spend a lot of time trying to find your friends.

Serafina: Okay.

Participant 3: Not a lot of time, but it's like it's an unnecessary amount of time just to find your friends. Usually, I, yeah, usually me and my friends just have like this one spot that we are in. So like if anyone needs to go, okay, we'll be right, we'll be right here. Because you won't be able to call them.

Serafina: So you need the reception to just like to find your friends, right?

Participant 3: Yes.

Serafina: Not for other things?

Participant 3: Uh, not really. Not really for my family or anything.

Participant 3: Because like, they know, like, they know where I am. And like, they know I can get home safe and it's fine.

Serafina: Okay.

Participant 3: Yeah.

Serafina: Okay. Okay, um, so if there were a way to communicate with your friends without constantly using or checking your phone or having to call them, what would you want it to be like?

Participant 3: Uh, I probably want it somewhere, something that I can possibly wear.

Participant 3: Because when you go to concerts, you try to bring as little as possible. And usually they have restrictions on like your bag size. So I would want it. And I'm scared that I'll lose it if I like open and close my bag everything. So I would want, preferably want something that I can wear.

Serafina: Oh, something you can wear.

Participant 3: Yes.

Serafina: Even if it's just like, um, if it's a similar, if there's already an app that is like similar to the wearable?

Participant 3: Yeah, sure. Yeah.

Serafina: Okay. Um, if you could get real time information about the venue during an event, what information would be most useful to you?

Participant 3: Uh, what information would be most useful? Obviously like run down like set times and if there's anything that changes.

Serafina: Okay.

Participant 3: Cause like in one of the, uh, one of the festivals I went, the artist couldn't make it. But like, we didn't know if that meant like the next artist is pushed forward or like the artist right now is pushed back. And that kind of like made it a bit like in a little awkward space.

Serafina: Oh, okay.

Participant 3: Cause you didn't know. Yeah. Cause the next, we were looking forward to the next one, but like, we don't know if we want it to stay in the crowd or not. And, um, what else? Maybe, yeah, maybe that could be it. Another thing I could think about is like lyrics, but like that won't fit in a wearable device.

Serafina: Maybe, maybe we can try. Um, so imagine you could design something that improved the way people experience concerts with their friends. So what would you want it to do? Other than that information thing?

Participant 3: Oh, I would want it to, I would maybe want it. So you can like link up the devices with your friends.

Serafina: Yeah.

Participant 3: So like, I don't give you like a little approximation on where your friend is. So that would be easier. Or maybe it has like a little, like not alarm. Cause that's a bit, cause that's going to distract people. But like some sort of indicator that says like, Oh, your friend is near.

Serafina: Okay.

Participant 3: Or if your friend is over here, like, or maybe some little, like we can send like little signals to each other. Like maybe the symbol, the symbol means that.

Serafina: Oh, that, that would be really nice. Um, and what would make you feel more comfortable and confident navigating a large concert or a festival on your own?

Participant 3: On my own, I feel like if I'm going on my own, I'm going to try to find someone to adopt me. Find someone else who's alone so we can tackle it together. Just, just for safety. Not because I don't think I can enjoy myself. I can enjoy being myself. Just…just like, it's nice to have someone else. So you don't get, so you don't get kidnapped or get squished.

Serafina: Okay so you just feel more comfortable if there's like other people around you?

Participant 3: Yeah.

Serafina: Okay, that would be all.

Participant 3: All right.

Serafina: Okay. Thank you so much.

INTERVIEW 4

Nayaka: Hi, thank you for helping me with this interview. Since we already know each other, I wanted to ask you because I know you have experience going to concerts and music festivals, and I think your perspective could be really useful for our project, especially because you also have personal experience with hearing difficulties. For DECO3500, my team is researching how technology could improve people's experience at concerts and music festivals. We are currently exploring an idea around a wearable wristband. It could potentially help friends stay connected when the venue is crowded or the phone signal is bad, and we are also considering features such as lights and vibrations that respond to music. Because the idea is still developing, I mainly want to understand your actual experiences first rather than just asking whether you like our idea. Before we start, is it okay if I record this conversation? The recording will only be used for our university project so I can accurately review and analyse your answers afterward.

Participant 4: Yes, that's okay. I consent to being recorded.

Nayaka: Thank you. Also, if there's anything you don't want to answer, that's completely fine. So firstly, can you tell me about the most recent concert or music festival you attended?

Participant 4: My last music festival was Pesta Rakyat 2025, where I saw Project Pop performing here in Brisbane. Before that, I also attended Jazz Goes to Campus back in my home country.

Nayaka: Oh okay, so you've experienced festivals both here in Brisbane and back home. What did you enjoy the most about attending them?

Participant 4: I think I enjoyed seeing some of my favourite singers and bands live. I feel like there is something different about hearing musicians perform their songs live. They're usually more energetic and more in tune with the mood of the audience.

Nayaka: Yeah, I understand. It's different from just listening through Spotify or watching them online because you're actually there with the artist and the crowd. Was there anything that made the experience difficult or frustrating?

Participant 4: The concerts and festivals are usually very crowded, and you may not get a good spot, especially if you don't buy VIP tickets. In the two recent festivals I mentioned, I was either placed at the back or too cramped with other people.
Another frustrating thing is the Wi-Fi or signal issue. It wasn't much of a problem at Pesta Rakyat, but it was an issue during Jazz Goes to Campus. Sometimes it was hard for me to reach my friends when we were separated.

Nayaka: So for you, the crowd itself isn't only about not getting a good view. It can also make it harder to move around and stay connected with your friends?

Participant 4: Yes, definitely.

Nayaka: Who do you normally go to concerts or festivals with, and how do you usually communicate with each other during the event?

Participant 4: I usually go with my friends. We normally communicate through group chats or private chats, either on WhatsApp or LINE.

Nayaka: Do you usually have a plan before going in, like deciding where to meet if someone gets separated, or do you mostly rely on messaging each other?

Participant 4: Usually we rely on messaging each other. Sometimes we also decide on a place to meet again, especially if we know we're going to separate.

Nayaka: Have you actually experienced being separated from your friends during an event?

Participant 4: Yes. During Jazz Goes to Campus, we separated into two groups because some of us had different preferences about which artists we wanted to see.
In that situation, we tried to text our friends from the other group. If one person's phone had a connection problem, another person would try to contact them instead. Then we would normally arrange to meet again at a certain spot.
There was also another time when I entered the event area much later than my friends because I got stuck in traffic. I couldn't reach them to say that I had already arrived because the signal was weak.
Eventually, I found them waiting near an entrance that I happened to pass. But I think it could have been a very different situation if I hadn't walked past that entrance or hadn't seen them there.

Nayaka: Yeah, because in that case finding them was partly luck. If you entered through another entrance, you might have spent much longer trying to find each other.

Participant 4: Exactly.

Nayaka: When something like that happens and you can't reach your friends, does it make you worried, or is it more just frustrating?

Participant 4: I think it's both. It can be frustrating because you don't know exactly where they are, and if you can't contact them, you also don't know if they're waiting for you somewhere or if they've moved somewhere else.

Nayaka: Out of poor phone reception, low battery, loud music, and crowded spaces, which ones affect communication the most for you?

Participant 4: Poor phone reception and crowded spaces are probably the two main issues for me.
Weak reception makes it harder to contact my friends and ask where they are. Crowded spaces also make it difficult to move around and physically find them.
I would say loud music can also make communication difficult, especially when I'm close to the stage or when the song is a louder type of music.

Nayaka: You mentioned before that you are hard of hearing in one ear and that you use hearing technology that helps you hear through both ears. Does a concert environment affect the way you communicate compared with normal situations?

Participant 4: Yes, I think so. In general, it's already pretty normal for everyone to have difficulty hearing people around them during a loud concert, but I guess it can be slightly more difficult for me because I'm hard of hearing in one ear.
The hearing technology helps me hear from both sides in normal situations, but concerts are very loud and crowded, so communication can still be difficult. If my friend is standing right beside me, especially on my better hearing side, I can usually communicate with them more easily. But if someone is trying to call my name from far away during a concert, I may not hear them.

Nayaka: That's interesting because even though the technology helps you hear through both sides, the concert environment still creates another layer of difficulty.

Participant 4: Yes, especially because there are so many sounds happening at the same time.

Nayaka: So even if your friend is physically quite close, calling your name might not always be an effective way of getting your attention?

Participant 4: Yes.

Nayaka: What about low battery? Has that ever become a major problem?

Participant 4: Not really. Low battery is usually not much of an issue because I normally bring my power bank, and my battery health is still pretty good.

Nayaka: So it sounds like network connection is more important for you than battery. During the actual performance, how often do you use your phone?

Participant 4: Quite often. I normally use my phone to record the performance.

Nayaka: Some people say using phones during concerts can distract them from being present. Do you feel that way?

Participant 4: Not really. I don't find it distracting because I use it to capture memories from the event.

Nayaka: Okay, so phone use itself isn't necessarily a problem for you. It's more that when you actually need your phone for communication, the connection might not work.

Participant 4: Yes, exactly.

Nayaka: I also wanted to ask about one part of our wearable idea. We are exploring whether music could be represented through vibration, for example allowing someone to feel parts of the rhythm or bass through the wristband. How would you personally feel about experiencing music in that way?

Participant 4: I'm unsure about this because I've never experienced musical elements solely through vibrations, so I can't really imagine what it would feel like.
Concerts are normally loud enough for me to hear and enjoy. Even though I'm hard of hearing in one ear, the music at concerts is usually loud enough that I can still experience it.
Most of the time, I don't even need to use my hearing technology during concerts because the music can become too loud when I use it.

Nayaka: That's actually really useful for us because we shouldn't assume that just because someone is hard of hearing, they automatically need or want vibration to experience music.

Participant 4: Yeah, I think it depends on the person.

Nayaka: So perhaps vibration could be an additional option rather than something that every hard-of-hearing user is expected to use?

Participant 4: Yes, I think that would be better.

Nayaka: If vibration was available as an optional feature, do you think continuous vibration could become distracting or uncomfortable?

Participant 4: Yes, it could become distracting or uncomfortable. I think if you're using vibrations, users should be able to adjust it like a volume button on devices.

Nayaka: So rather than just having vibration on or off, you would want control over how strong it is?

Participant 4: Yes. I think people should be able to adjust it based on what feels comfortable for them.

Nayaka: And probably turn it off completely if they don't want it?

Participant 4: Yes.

Nayaka: Another area we're looking at is finding information around the venue. Have you ever experienced difficulty finding things like seating, toilets, exits, quiet spaces, accessible areas, or other event information?

Participant 4: Yes, especially when the map provided by the organiser is confusing. Though often there are signs that help guide me to the right place.

Nayaka: Would you normally look at the map on your phone first, or would you mostly follow the physical signs around the venue?

Participant 4: I think it depends. If I already have the map, I might look at that, but if the map is confusing, then the physical signs are usually more useful.

Nayaka: Okay, so any navigation technology would need to be simpler than just showing another complicated map.

Participant 4: Yes, I think so.

Nayaka: If you needed a break, wanted some help, or just wanted to separate from your friends for a while, how would you normally let them know?

Participant 4: I just tell them directly if they're with me, or by text if they're not with me.

Nayaka: And if the signal was poor at that moment, would that create the same communication problem we talked about earlier?

Participant 4: Yes. If they're not with me and I can't send the message properly, then it would be difficult for them to know what I'm doing.

Nayaka: Right. Last question. Based on everything you've experienced, if you could improve just one thing about concerts or music festivals, what would you change?

Participant 4: I think improving signals or reception at the concert or festival area so that it's easier to connect to others or access information that we need.

Nayaka: So staying connected would probably be a bigger priority for you than adding lots of completely new entertainment features?

Participant 4: Yes. I think being able to contact people and access information reliably would be really useful.

Nayaka: That's really helpful. One important thing I've learned from what you said is that being hard of hearing doesn't automatically mean someone experiences concerts in the same way as every other hard-of-hearing person. In your case, you are hard of hearing in one ear and use hearing technology that helps you hear through both ears, but at concerts you may not even

want to use it because the sound is already very loud.
So for our project, vibration shouldn't be something we assume every hard-of-hearing attendee needs. It should probably be optional and adjustable. At the same time, difficulty communicating and finding friends when reception is poor seems like a much clearer problem from your experience.

Participant 4: Yes, I agree.

Nayaka: Thank you. This was really useful for our research and for deciding which parts of the concept we should focus on. Thanks again for letting me record the interview.

Participant 4: No worries, Good Luck.

INTERVIEW 5

Syifa: Okay, so the first question is: Can you tell me about the most recent concert or music festival you attended?

Participant 5: The most recent concert I attended was last January. It was actually not in Australia; it was abroad, in Jakarta. It was a K-pop concert, and I would say that I had a fun time.

Syifa: What group?

Participant 5: It's called ATEEZ. It's a really dope K-pop group.

Syifa: What did you enjoy the most, and what was difficult or frustrating during the event?

Participant 5: What I enjoyed the most was obviously the performance itself because they're my favorite band, so I was really excited to see them live. Especially because I got the standing section, so I could see them up close.

Another thing I liked was that, since I was in the VIP section, it was pretty coordinated in terms of how we entered the venue. The event organizers made sure that we didn't all go in at the same time, so it was very organized.

Syifa: You got a queue number?

Participant 5: Yes, I got a queue number. But one difficult thing was that I was separated from my friend at one point. She was in the same section as me, but we had different queue numbers, and hers was quite far from mine. My queue number had to go in first, so I was waiting for her because I didn't want to be separated from her. But eventually, I saw her inside, so it was all good.

Syifa: Who did you go with, and how did your group normally communicate or coordinate during the event?

Participant 5: As I mentioned before, I went with my friend. We communicated through a messaging app, WhatsApp, because I have her number. I could just text her things like, “Hey, I’m here.”

I remember there was one time when she was still waiting in line to get a drink, and she asked me to wait for her. So basically, we coordinated through a messaging app.

Syifa: Have you ever been separated from your friends at a concert or festival? What happened, and how did you find each other again?

Participant 5: Yeah, I have been separated, and I think I mentioned it earlier. We got separated because my queue number went in first, while hers came in later.
I found her because I eventually saw her. While everyone was gathering near the stage, I stood a little further back so I could see the people coming in. Once I saw her, I went to her, and then we went closer to the stage together.

Syifa: Have poor phone reception, low battery, loud music, or crowded spaces ever made it difficult to communicate with your group?

Participant 5: Yeah, definitely. All of those things have made it harder. For example, with phone reception, there was one time when my friend was buying a drink and I was waiting for her. I was texting her, “Yo, we have to be quick. They’re telling us to go inside.” But the message didn’t come through because her signal was bad. The area was inside a hall and it was really crowded, so the reception was really bad.

For low battery, there was another concert last year where I didn’t bring a power bank because I thought my phone being at 100% would be enough. It wasn’t. I ended up borrowing a power bank from the girl next to me, and luckily she was nice enough to lend it to me.

For loud music, at the recent concert they were playing with a live band, so the music was really loud. There were so many times when my friend was talking to me and I kept saying, “What? What? Huh?” because I couldn’t hear her. There was also another time when a girl was talking to me, and I just laughed along even though I couldn’t hear what she said.

Crowded spaces were also a problem because I was in the standing section near the front. It was really crowded, I couldn’t move much, and it felt kind of suffocating.

Syifa: How often did you use your phone during the event, and did using it ever distract you from the performance?

Participant 5: I mostly used my phone to record. I usually put my phone on Do Not Disturb because I don’t want incoming texts or calls to interrupt me while I’m recording. But there was

one time when I got a text from my group mate in the middle of the performance, so I had to reply really quickly about our project. After that, I turned Do Not Disturb back on and continued recording.

Syifa: Did using your phone distract you from the performance?

Participant 5: Obviously, yeah. I had to take my eyes away from the performance to look at the text. Who knows what I could have seen on stage during that time? My attention was on my phone, so it was definitely distracting.

Syifa: How would you feel about experiencing rhythm, bass, or other musical elements through vibration?

Participant 5: I think it's very interesting. I wouldn't mind it. Sometimes when you're standing at a concert, you can already feel the music vibration.

There was one time when the bass was so strong that I could feel it in my chest. It felt kind of weird, but in a good way, because it made me feel really immersed in the performance.

Syifa: Could continuous vibration become distracting or uncomfortable?

Participant 5: Oh, totally. Even sometimes when my phone keeps vibrating for too long because of a phone call, I get really irritated. So yeah, it could definitely become distracting or uncomfortable.

Syifa: Should users be able to adjust or disable it?

Participant 5: I think they should be able to disable it whenever they want because if it keeps going, it could make them uncomfortable. They should also be able to adjust it whenever they want based on their own preferences. There doesn't need to be a specific time; they should just be able to change it whenever they need to.

Syifa: Have you experienced any difficulty accessing things such as seating, toilets, exits, quiet spaces, or information in other areas?

Participant 5: Yes, definitely. Maybe not seating or accessible areas because usually they guide you for seating, but I've definitely had difficulty with toilets.

There was one time when I wanted to go to the toilet and security showed me where it was, but when I arrived, it was really crowded. Then I tried another toilet, and that one was also really crowded, so I had to look around for another option.

Syifa: Did you see any signs for the toilets?

Participant 5: If I remember correctly, there were signs. The problem was more that the toilets were usually crowded, so you had to look for other options.

Syifa: Did they provide many toilets?

Participant 5: Yeah, there were obviously a lot of toilets in the venue, but there were also a lot of people, so you had to take turns.

Syifa: When you needed a break, needed help, or wanted to separate from your group for a while, how did you communicate this to your friend?

Participant 5: If my friend was next to me, I would usually tap her on the shoulder. If the music was loud, I would just yell something like, “Yo, I need to take a break,” or, “I need to sit down,” and she would understand.

Syifa: How about if you were separated?

Participant 5: If we were separated, we would just text each other. But we would have to hope that the bad signal wouldn’t interfere with our communication.

Syifa: If you could improve one thing about the concert or festival experience, what would you change and why?

Participant 5: Based on everything I’ve experienced, I would definitely improve communication with friends or other people. When you’re at a concert, it’s really crowded. There was one time after a concert when I wanted to contact my driver, but I couldn’t because there were so many people and the signal was really bad.

It’s also important for communication with friends because you can easily get separated. I think it would be helpful if there was an easy and convenient way to reach each other without it being troublesome. Personally, if I’m in a really crowded place with strangers and I can’t see my friend, I would panic. Having no signal at the same time would make me panic and freak out even more.

Syifa: Okay, that’s all for the questions. Thank you so much for participating.

Participant 5: Thank you.